Conference abstract

Structured abstract (250–300 words) and poster layout guide

Foundations of Clinical Research · Session 8 (8.2 Getting published) · Template version 1.0

Conference: *[Name, year; abstract deadline]*

Category / topic: *[As listed by the conference]*

Preference: ☐ Oral ☐ Poster ☐ Either

Word limit: *[e.g. 300 words, excluding title and authors (check the call)]*

Conference abstracts are judged in a few minutes: one clear question, real numbers, one message. Results must be available (or nearly) when you submit. Never write "results will be presented". Follow the conference format exactly; most do not allow tables or references.

Title: *[Informative title, ≤ 20 words, the design in it]*

Authors and affiliations: *[Presenting author underlined; Department, Institution]*

Section	Words	Content	Your text
Background	40–50	Problem, gap, aim	*[Write here]*
Methods	70–80	Design, setting, participants, exposure/intervention, primary outcome, analysis	*[Write here]*
Results	90–110	n; primary outcome per group; effect size (95% CI); one secondary result	*[Write here]*
Conclusions	30–40	Answer + implication, matched to the design	*[Write here]*

Total words: *[n]* / limit *[n]*

> **Example (FICTIONAL):** *Background: Fluid accumulation in septic shock is associated with death, but routine ICU data are scarce. We described fluid balance in our ICU and its association with 28-day mortality. Methods: Prospective cohort of adults with sepsis ... Results: Of 270 patients alive at day 5, 68 (25%) died by day 28; each 10 ml/kg increase in cumulative balance was associated with higher odds of death (adjusted OR 1.12, 95% CI 1.03–1.22). Conclusions: ... [Fictional numbers.]*

Poster layout guide

A poster is read from 1.5–2 metres in about 1 minute. Three columns, read top-left to bottom-right; figures instead of text; one take-home message in a box. Check the conference size (often A0 portrait, 84 × 119 cm).

TITLE (≥ 85 pt) · authors · affiliations · logos		
1 Background 2–3 bullets: problem, gap, aim	**3 Results: main figure** The primary outcome as a figure (e.g. bar or dot plot with 95% CI, or Kaplan–Meier curve). Largest element on the poster.	**5 KEY MESSAGE** One sentence in a coloured box, large font
2 Methods Flow diagram or design picture; setting; participants; outcome; analysis in 3 lines	**4 Results: Table 1 (short) or second figure**	**6 Conclusions & limitations** 3 bullets
References (3–5, small) · funding · ethics approval · contact email · QR code to the abstract or paper		

Rule	Guide
Text size	Title ≥ 85 pt; headings ≥ 36 pt; body ≥ 24 pt (readable from 1.5 m)
Amount of text	≤ 800 words in total; bullets, not paragraphs
Figures	Large, simple, labelled axes with units; the same colour for the same group everywhere
Numbers	Effect sizes with 95% CI, as in the abstract. The numbers must match
Colours	2–3 colours plus grey; dark text on a light background; check colour-blind safety
At the poster	A 1-minute spoken summary; A4 handouts or a QR code